2000s and 2010s, given its economic slowdown. American defense planners increased their reliance on unmanned systems, hypersonics, underwater systems, and cyberwar capabilities. Both increased their espionage activities and conducted a regular military cat-and-mouse game in the skies and on the waters of the region. As of this writing, the two antagonists have so far avoided outright conflict and a repeat of the Littoral War, perhaps as much through luck as through a wariness on both sides to stumble once again into armed conflict.

Notes

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